

**Expungement Award
FINRA Dispute Resolution Services**

In the Matter of the Arbitration Between:

Claimant

Aaron Matthew Stark

Case Number: 25-00922

vs.

Respondent

Northwestern Mutual Investment Services, LLC

Hearing Site: Wichita, Kansas

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are appointed pursuant to Rule 13806 of the Code of Arbitration Procedure (“Code”) to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

Nature of the Dispute: Associated Person vs. Member

The expungement hearing was conducted by videoconference.

REPRESENTATION OF PARTIES

For Claimant Aaron Matthew Stark (“Claimant”): Peter Lindholm, Esq. and Dochtor Kennedy, Esq., AdvisorLaw, Broomfield, Colorado.

For Respondent Northwestern Mutual Investment Services, LLC (“Respondent”): Clarke C. Greene, Esq., Northwestern Mutual Law Department, Milwaukee, Wisconsin.

CASE INFORMATION

Statement of Claim filed on or about: May 6, 2025.

Claimant signed the Submission Agreement: May 6, 2025.

Statement of Answer filed on or about: June 25, 2025.

Respondent signed the Submission Agreement: June 23, 2025.

CASE SUMMARY

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant asserted a claim seeking expungement of customer dispute information from registration records maintained by the Central Registration Depository (“CRD”).

Unless specifically admitted in the Statement of Answer, Respondent denied the allegations made in the Statement of Claim, asserted various affirmative defenses, and did not oppose Claimant’s request for expungement.

RELIEF REQUESTED

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant (CRD Number 6631119) requested expungement of all references to Occurrence Number 2326052 from the CRD registration records and any and all other relief that the Panel deems just and equitable.

In the Statement of Answer, Respondent did not request any relief.

OTHER ISSUES CONSIDERED AND DECIDED

The Arbitrators acknowledge that they have each read the pleadings and other materials filed by the parties.

On May 7, 2025, Claimant advised that the customers in Occurrence Number 2326052 ("Customers") were served with a copy of the Statement of Claim within 10 days of filing the Statement of Claim. On May 13, 2025, Claimant filed an Affidavit confirming that the Customers were served with a copy of the Statement of Claim and provided proof of service.

On May 24, 2025, the Customers submitted a written statement and opposed the expungement request.

On June 4, 2025, the Customers registered for the DR Portal, providing them with access to all documents filed in the case.

On June 26, 2025, Claimant advised that the Customers were served with a copy of the Statement of Answer within 10 days of its filing. On June 30, 2025, Claimant filed an Affidavit confirming that the Customers were served with a copy of the Statement of Answer and provided proof of service.

On October 24, 2025, the authorized representative of the state securities regulator for Kansas submitted a written statement and opposed the expungement request.

The Panel conducted a recorded hearing by videoconference on November 3, 2025, so the parties could present oral argument and evidence on Claimant's request for expungement. Claimant appeared by videoconference at the expungement hearing. Respondent appeared at the expungement hearing and, as stated in the Statement of Answer, did not oppose the request for expungement.

The Customers did not appear at the expungement hearing.

The authorized representatives of the state securities regulator for Kansas appeared at the expungement hearing by videoconference and opposed the expungement request.

AWARD

After considering the pleadings, the testimony and evidence presented at the expungement hearing, and any post-hearing submissions, the Panel has decided in full and final resolution of the issues submitted for determination as follows:

1. Claimant's request for expungement of Occurrence Number 2326052 from registration records maintained by the CRD is denied with prejudice. Claimant did not prove that expungement was appropriate. The Panel's decision was unanimous.
2. Any and all claims for relief not specifically addressed herein are denied.

FEES

Pursuant to the Code, the following fees are assessed:

Filing Fees

FINRA Dispute Resolution Services assessed a filing fee* for each claim:

Initial Claim Filing Fee	= \$ 2,000.00
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**The filing fee is made up of a non-refundable and a refundable portion.*

Member Fees

Member fees are assessed to each member firm that is a party in these proceedings or to the member firm(s) that employed the associated person(s) at the time of the event(s) giving rise to the dispute. Accordingly, as a party, Respondent is assessed the following:

Member Surcharge	= \$ 2,600.00
Member Process Fee	= \$ 5,005.00

Hearing Session Fees and Assessments

The Panel has assessed hearing session fees for each session conducted. A session is any meeting between the parties and the Arbitrator(s), including a pre-hearing conference with the Arbitrator(s), which lasts four (4) hours or less. Fees associated with these proceedings are:

One (1) pre-hearing session with the Panel @ \$1,725.00/session	= \$ 1,725.00
Pre-Hearing Conference: August 7, 2025 1 session	
One (1) hearing session on expungement request @ \$1,725.00/session	= \$ 1,725.00
Hearing: November 3, 2025 1 session	
Total Hearing Session Fees	= \$ 3,450.00

The Panel has assessed the total hearing session fees to Claimant.

All balances are payable to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services and are due upon receipt.

ARBITRATION PANEL

Howard N. Gorney	-	Public Arbitrator, Presiding Chairperson
Richard J. Grahn	-	Public Arbitrator
George G. Kurschner	-	Public Arbitrator

I, the undersigned Arbitrator, do hereby affirm that I am the individual described herein and who executed this instrument, which is my award.

Concurring Arbitrators' Signatures

Howard N. Gorney

Howard N. Gorney
Public Arbitrator, Presiding Chairperson

11/05/2025

Signature Date

Richard J. Grahn

Richard J. Grahn
Public Arbitrator

11/06/2025

Signature Date

George G. Kurschner

George G. Kurschner
Public Arbitrator

11/05/2025

Signature Date

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November 06, 2025

Date of Service (For FINRA Dispute Resolution Services use only)